

OpenAI — Credential Setup Guide

This guide walks you through creating an OpenAI account and getting the API key that powers your AI agent's understanding and voice. No coding required.

This is the quickest of the three (about 10 minutes). The only thing to watch is **enabling billing** and confirming **Realtime API** access for voice.

What we need from you (the end goal)

#	Credential	Looks like
1	API Key	starts with <code>sk- . . .</code> , a long string

That's the only credential. There are a couple of account settings to confirm too (Steps 3–4). How to send it securely is at the bottom.

Step 1 — Create an OpenAI account

1. Go to <https://platform.openai.com/signup>
2. Sign up with your **work email** (or Google/Microsoft login)
3. Verify your email and phone number if prompted

Note: This is the **API platform** (platform.openai.com), which is different from ChatGPT. Even if you already pay for ChatGPT Plus, the API is billed separately — you still need to do Step 3.

Step 2 — Set up your organization (if prompted)

1. Enter your **business/organization name**
2. This name appears on invoices — use your company name

Step 3 — Add billing (required)

The API doesn't work until a payment method is on file. This is **separate** from any ChatGPT subscription.

1. Go to **Settings** → **Billing** (<https://platform.openai.com/account/billing>)
2. Click **Add payment method**, enter a card
3. Add an initial credit balance (e.g. **\$20–50** to start) — the agent draws from this as it's used
4. *(Recommended)* Set a **monthly usage limit** and an **email alert threshold** under **Billing** → **Limits** so there are no surprises

Our team will share expected monthly cost estimates separately. Voice (Realtime) is the largest driver — we'll keep you informed before any large bills.

Step 4 — Confirm Realtime API access (for voice)

The voice feature uses OpenAI's **Realtime API**. On most accounts this is available automatically once billing is active, but let's confirm.

1. Go to <https://platform.openai.com/docs/models>
2. In the model list, look for a model named like **gpt-4o-realtime-preview** (or "Realtime")
3. If you can see it listed, you're good
4. If you get an "access" or "not available" message, contact OpenAI support (or let us know) — sometimes it needs a quick verification step on newer accounts

Step 5 — Create the API key

1. Go to <https://platform.openai.com/api-keys>
2. Click **Create new secret key**
3. Name it (e.g. "Veerox Agent")
4. (Optional) Set permissions to **All** (default)
5. Click **Create secret key**
6. **Copy it immediately** — it starts with `sk-...` ← *credential #1*

Important: OpenAI shows the key **only once**. If you close the window without copying, just delete it and create a new one.

How to send us the credential (securely)

The API key spends real money from your balance, so **please don't paste it into plain WhatsApp or email**.

Preferred options (any one): - A password manager shared note (1Password, Bitwarden "Send", etc.) - A temporary secret-sharing link (e.g. <https://onetimesecret.com>)

Send us:

OpenAI API Key: `sk-_____`

Quick troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
"You exceeded your quota"	Your credit balance is empty or no card is on file. Add billing (Step 3).
"Model not found: gpt-4o-realtime-preview"	Realtime access isn't active yet — confirm Step 4 or contact OpenAI support.
Lost the key	Delete it on the API Keys page and create a new one — tell us so we swap it in.
Worried about overspend	Set a hard monthly limit under Billing → Limits (Step 3).

A note on safety

- You can **revoke** the key any time from the API Keys page — it stops working instantly. Useful if you ever suspect it leaked.
- You own this key and the account. We only use it to run your agent; you can rotate it whenever you like and we'll do a one-line swap on our side.

Questions at any step? Send us a screenshot — happy to help.